

THE TARGET · BIG 5 MIDFIELDERS 2015/16

N'Golo Kanté

Age 24 **€20.0m** | **3,180 min · 37 apps · 33 starts**

Positions: LDM · RDM · LCM · RCM · CAM · LM

RANK OF 413, PER 90

TACKLES	INTERCEPTS	RECOVERIES	BLOCKS	ENGAGE.
1st	3rd	7th	9th	12th

STRENGTHS

Tackles · Interceptions · Recoveries · Blocks

WEAKNESSES

Danger stopped · Dribbled past · Give-and-gos · Prog passes

STYLE

Wins the ball · Presses hard · Secure under pressure

01 BALL-WINNING

	value	pct
Engagements p90	36.63	97
Tackles p90	4.64	100
Interceptions p90	3.11	100
Ball recoveries p90	8.49	99
Regain %	42.3	77
Direct regain %	37.1	78
Indirect regain %	5.3	51

02 COVER & DISRUPT

	value	pct
Pressures p90	25.65	89
Pressures /30 OTIP	14.02	89
Counterpresses p90	10.56	96
Blocks p90	3.23	98
Danger stopped %	30.1	24
Dribbled past p90	1.67	30

03 ON-BALL RELIABILITY

	value	pct
Possessions retained %	82.6	72
Keep under pressure %	83.9	85
Pass completion %	81.4	62
Turnovers p90	10.84	74
Miscontrols p90	1.25	48
Dispossessed p90	1.42	43
Danger under pressure p90	7.93	65

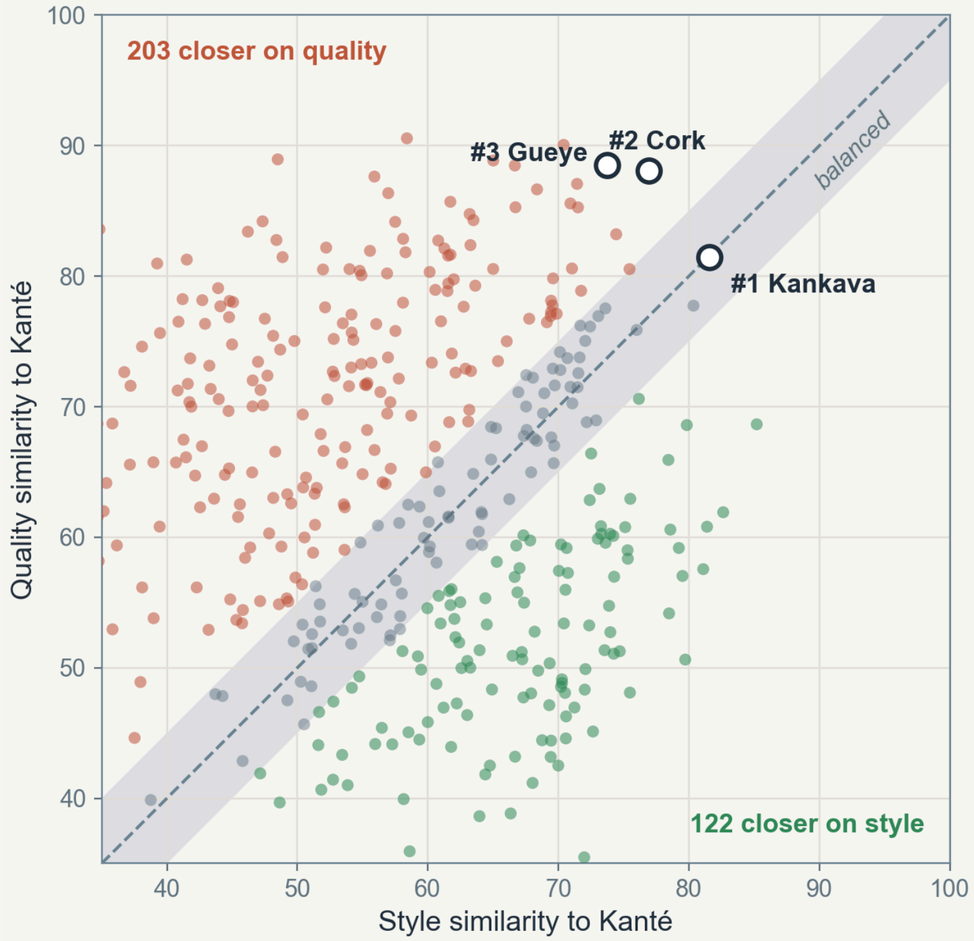
04 PROGRESSION

	value	pct
Progressive passes p90	9.45	40
Progressive carries p90	5.27	66
Long carries p90	9.91	59
Passes /30 TIP	27.26	60
Build-up possessions p90	24.88	39
Finishing possessions p90	14.35	48
Give-and-gos /30 TIP	0.63	32

Benchmark: 413 Big 5 midfielders with 900+ minutes. Percentiles vs that pool, StatsBomb open data 2015/16. Dribbled past, turnovers, miscontrols and dispossessed are inverted.

TWIN TEST · HOW TWINS ARE PICKED

How the twin ranking works



Each dot is one of 412 candidates. The shaded band is within 5 points of balanced; red sits closer on quality, green closer on style.

01 Pool

413 Big 5 midfielders with 900+ minutes in 2015/16.

02 Style, 16 metrics

What he does: engagements, pressing, blocks, carries, passing volume and build-up role.

03 Quality, 9 metrics

How well he does it: regains, danger stopped, ball retention, pass completion, turnovers.

04 Blend 60 / 40

Distance to Kanté on each block, weighted 60% style and 40% quality. 100 would be identical.

The top three score 79.6 to 81.5; the median candidate scores 60.5.

4-10: Illarramendi 79.3 · Petros 78.6 · Lacen 78.3 · Dembélé 77.9 · Wanyama 77.7 · Fernández 77.5 · Recio 77.0

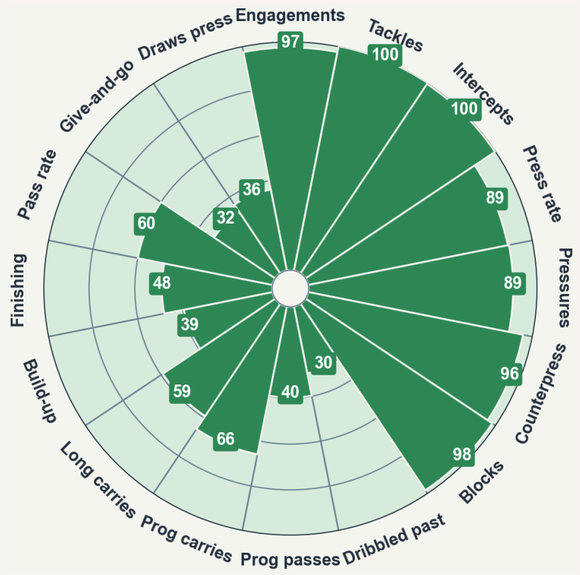
TWIN TEST · STYLE

Deeper Look: Style similarity

TARGET

N'Golo Kanté

Leicester · Premier League

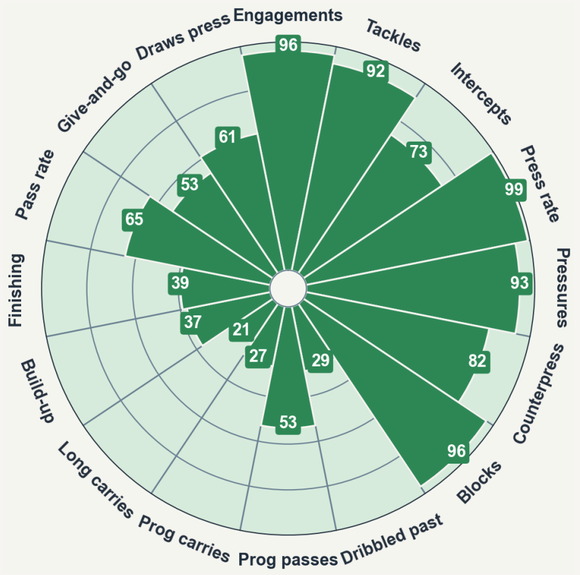


TWIN #1

Jaba Kankava

Reims · Ligue 1

81.6 style match

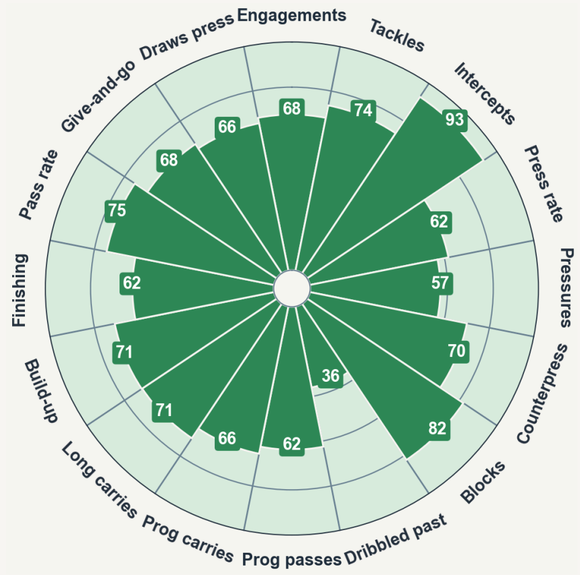


TWIN #2

Jack Cork

Swansea · Premier League

76.9 style match

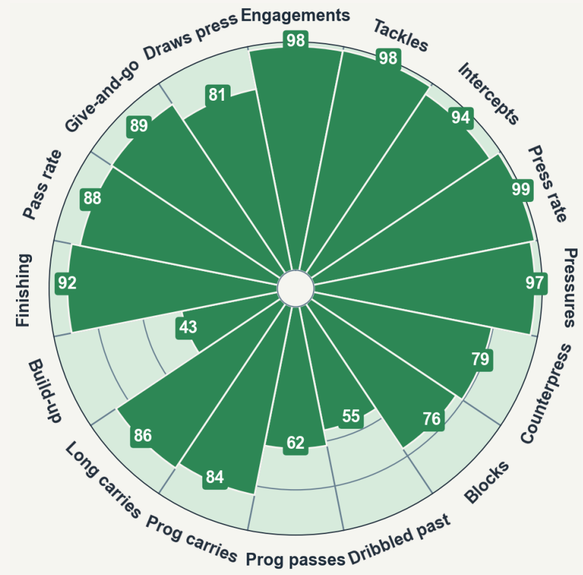


TWIN #3

Idrissa Gueye

Aston Villa · Premier League

73.7 style match



STYLE

Engagements: Pressures, tackles, interceptions and blocks, per 90.

Press rate: Pressures per 30 minutes out of possession.

Counterpress: Pressures right after the team loses the ball, per 90.

Dribbled past: Times beaten 1v1, per 90. Inverted: lower raw is a higher percentile.

Prog passes: Passes that move the ball meaningfully toward goal, per 90.

Prog carries: Carries that advance the ball meaningfully toward goal, per 90.

Long carries: Longer carries by duration, per 90.

Build-up: Possessions that start in the defensive third, per 90.

Finishing: Possessions that reach the final third, per 90.

Pass rate: Passes per 30 minutes in possession.

Give-and-go: One-twos completed while in possession, per 30 TIP minutes.

Draws press: On-ball actions that attract opponent pressure, per 30 TIP minutes.

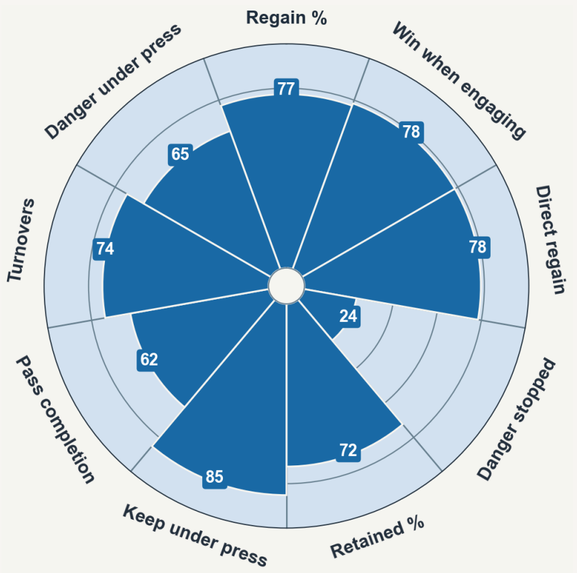
TWIN TEST · QUALITY

Deeper Look: Quality similarity

TARGET

N'Golo Kanté

Leicester · Premier League

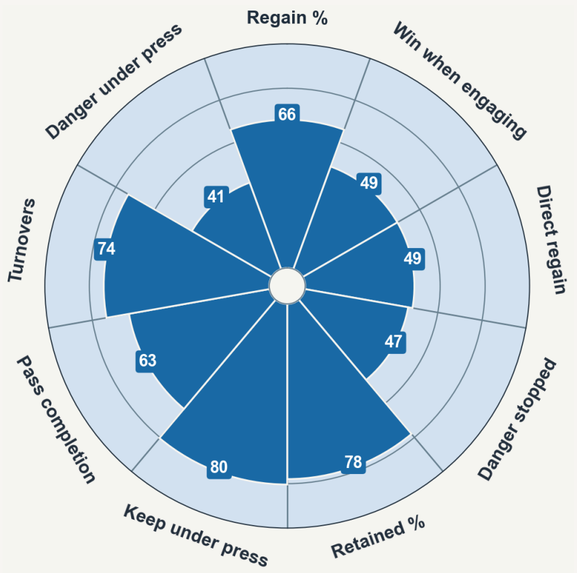


TWIN #1

Jaba Kankava

Reims · Ligue 1

81.4 quality match

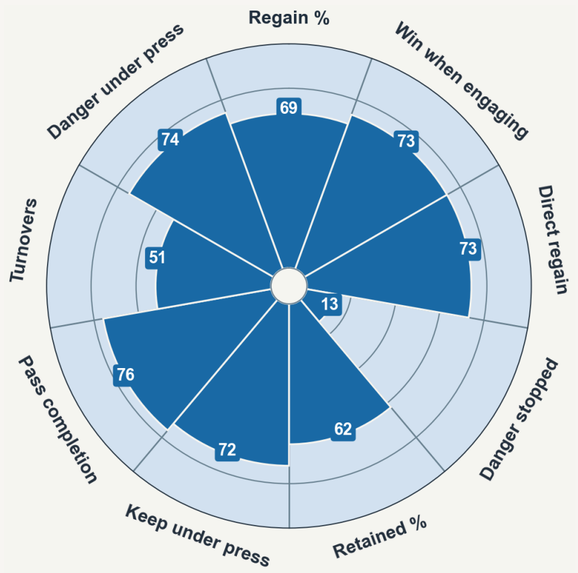


TWIN #2

Jack Cork

Swansea · Premier League

88.1 quality match

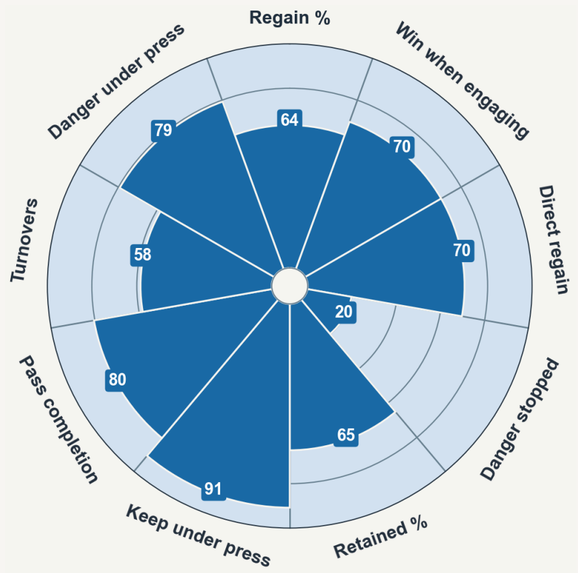


TWIN #3

Idrissa Gueye

Aston Villa · Premier League

88.5 quality match



QUALITY

Regain %: Share of engagements followed by a regain (direct or indirect).

Win when engaging: Share of engagements where this player wins the ball directly.

Direct regain: Tackle won, interception won or recovery after an engagement.

Danger stopped: Share of dangerous sequences where the press stops or reduces the threat.

Retained %: Share of possessions involved in that the team keeps.

Keep under press: Share of on-ball actions under pressure that stay on the team.

Pass completion: Completed passes ÷ attempted passes.

Turnovers: Miscontrols, dispossessions and failed passes/dribbles, per 90. Inverted.

Danger under press: Dangerous on-ball moments while under pressure, per 90.

TWIN TEST · VERDICT

Top three twins side by side



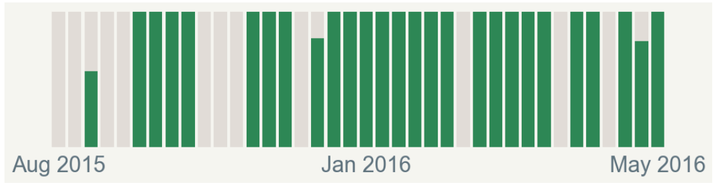
Jaba Kankava

Age **29** **€4.0m**

LDM · RDM · CDM · LCM · RCM · CAM

STADE REIMS

LEAGUE MINUTES BY MATCH



68.8% of minutes · 27 starts, 27 of 38 matches

Engagements	96
Tackles	92
Interceptions	73
Press rate	99
Regain %	66
Keep under press	80
Prog carries	27
Prog passes	53

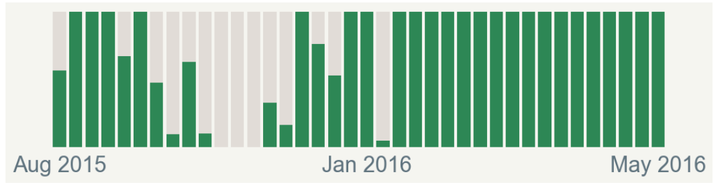


Jack Cork

Age **26** **€4.0m**

RCM · LCM · CDM · LDM · RDM · LW · CF

LEAGUE MINUTES BY MATCH



74.6% of minutes · 28 starts, 35 of 38 matches

Engagements	68
Tackles	74
Interceptions	93
Press rate	62
Regain %	69
Keep under press	72
Prog carries	66
Prog passes	62

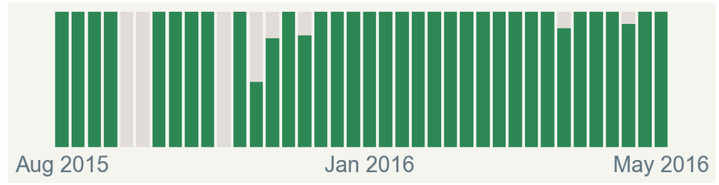


Idrissa Gueye

Age **26** **€9.0m**

LCM · CDM · LDM · RCM · RDM · CAM

LEAGUE MINUTES BY MATCH



89.1% of minutes · 35 starts, 35 of 38 matches

Engagements	98
Tackles	98
Interceptions	94
Press rate	99
Regain %	64
Keep under press	91
Prog carries	84
Prog passes	62

Age and market value from Transfermarkt for the 2015/16 season. Bars are each twin's percentile; the dark tick is Kanté's.